

Cassandra Bell

cassandra.bell@rutgers.edu | www.linkedin.com/in/cassandra-bell-ru27

EDUCATION

- 2022-Present **Rutgers University—Newark**, Newark, NJ
PhD Candidate, Developmental Psychology
Advisor: Vanessa LoBue, Ph.D.
- 2014-2018 **University of Florida**, Gainesville, FL
BS in Psychology- Behavioral and Cognitive Neuroscience
summa cum laude
- 2014-2018 **University of Florida**, Gainesville, FL
BA in Women's Studies
Thesis (highest honors): *Feminist Interventions for Women in STEM: The Effectiveness of STEM Undergraduate Student Organizations*.
Thesis committee: Alyssa Zucker, Ph.D. (chair); Bonnie Moradi, Ph.D.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

**denotes equal contribution from each author*

- Dennis, N.J., Bulgin, T., Nicastrì, C., **Bell, C.**, Delgado, M.R. (2024). Emotion Regulation Under Stress: A Social Processing and Memory Perspective. *Current Topics in Behavioral Neuroscience*, Springer.
- ***Bell, C.**, *Bierstedt, L., *Hu, T., *Ogren, M., *Reider, L., LoBue, V. (2024). Learning Through Language: The Importance of Emotion and Mental State Language for Children's Social and Emotional Learning. *Social and Emotional Learning: Research, Practice, and Policy*.
- Anzures, G., Mildort, M., **Bell, C.**, & Soethe, E. (2023) Visual Examination of Own- and Other-race Face Identities is Influenced by Implicit Racial Bias. *Current Psychology*.
- Conley, M.I., Rapuano, K.M., Benson-Williams, C., Rosenberg, M.D., Watts, R., **Bell, C.**, Casey, B.J., & Baskin-Sommers, A. (2023). Executive network activation moderates the association between neighborhood threats and externalizing behavior in youth. *Research on Child and Adolescent Psychopathology*.
- Anzures, G., Mildort, M., Fennell, E., **Bell, C.**, & Soethe E. (2022). Race and early face-sensitive event-related potentials in children and adults. *Journal of Experimental Child Psychology*.
- Simmons, C., **Bell, C.**, & Baskin-Sommers, A. (2022). Using psychological science to understand legal system involvement among adolescents. *The Clinical Psychologist*.

INVITED TALKS

- Grench, G., Waddell, J., **Bell, C.**, Hu, T., Pérez-Edgar, K., Buss, K.A., LoBue, V. (2026, March 13). *Examining the Influence of Household Chaos and Parent Emotionality on Infant Attention to Emotion*. The 13th Annual Society for Affective Science (SAS) Conference. Pittsburgh, PA, USA.

- Bell, C.** (2025, October 21). *Exploring the Role of Social Anxiety on Maladaptive Emotion Regulation Strategies*. Social Relationships Across the Lifespan, Rutgers University—Newark. Newark, NJ, USA.
- Bell, C.** (2024, May 21). *The Effects of Gun Violence on Threat Processing*. New Jersey Gun Violence Research Center Research Day (conference held online).
- Bell, C.** (2023, May 12). *The Effects of Gun Violence on Threat Processing*. New Jersey Gun Violence Research Center Research Day (conference held online).

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

[†] indicates trainees

- Kwon, S., **Bell, C.**, Thomsen, M., Derrell, A., Lobue, V. & Delgado, M.R. (2026, April). *Social buffering of the effect of community violence on risk taking*. Poster presented at the Social and Affective Neuroscience Conference, San Diego, California, USA.
- Bell, C.**, Thomsen, M., Bhanji, J., Delgado, M., Lobue, V. (2026, March). *The Role of Exposure To Gun Violence on Emotion Response and Regulation*. Poster presented at the annual meeting of the Society for Affective Science, Pittsburgh, PA, United States.
- [†] Lanterman, E., **Bell, C.**, Delgado, M., LoBue, V. (2026, March). *The Relationship Between Frequency and Type of Exposure to Violence and Anxiety in College Students*. Poster presented at the annual meeting of the Society for Affective Science, Pittsburgh, PA, United States.
- Bell, C.**, Smith, K. E., Buss, K. A., Pérez-Edgar, K., & LoBue, V. (2025, October). *The Role of Neighborhood Environment on Infant Attention to Emotion Faces*. Poster presented at the biennial Princeton Summit on Affective Science, Princeton, NJ, United States.
- [†]Djeukeng, D., **Bell, C.**, Lanterman, E., Hu, T. A., Bhanji, J. P., Delgado, M., & LoBue, V. (2025, August). *The Influence of Neighborhood Collective Efficacy on Emotion Regulation for Those Exposed to Community Violence*. Poster presented at the Rutgers Summer Undergraduate Research Institute, Newark, NJ, United States.
- [†]Waddell, J., **Bell, C.**, Hu, T. A., Pérez-Edgar, K., Buss, K. A., LoBue, V. (2025, August). *Exploring Relationships Between Parent Emotionality, Household Chaos, and Infant Attention to Threat*. Poster presented at the Rutgers Summer Undergraduate Research Institute, Newark, NJ, United States.
- Bell, C.**, Smith, K. E., Buss, K. A., Pérez-Edgar, K., & LoBue, V. (2025, May). *The Role of Neighborhood Environment on Infant Attention to Emotion Faces*. Poster presented at the annual meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Minneapolis, MN, United States.
- [†]Meza, D. C., [†]Munayco, K., **Bell, C.**, Hu, T. A., Pérez-Edgar, K., Buss, K. A., & LoBue, V. (2025, April). *Infant Negative Affect and Attention Bias Development: A Longitudinal Analysis*. Poster presented at the annual Rutgers University Research Week, Newark, NJ, United States. Awarded second place out of 39 posters.
- Bell, C.**, Buss, K. A., Pérez-Edgar, K., & LoBue, V. (2024, October). *The relationship between neighborhood disadvantage and infant attentional biases*. Poster presented at the annual meeting of the International Society for Developmental Psychobiology, Chicago, IL, United States.
- [†]Santibanez, A., **Bell, C.**, Cerda-Lopez, R., & LoBue, V. (2024). *The Influence of Neighborhood Collective Efficacy on Neighborhood Perceptions*. Poster presented at the Summer Undergraduate Research Institute, Newark, NJ, United States.

- ^tGrise, J., **Bell, C.**, Bhanji, J., Delgado, M., & LoBue, V. (2024). *The Influence of Gun Violence Exposure on Risk-Taking Behavior*. Poster presented at the annual Rutgers University Research Week, Newark, NJ, United States.
- ^tLevine, S., **Bell, C.**, Bhanji, J., Delgado, M., LoBue, V. (2024). *The Influence of Gun Violence on Depressive Symptoms*. Poster presented at the annual Rutgers University Research Week, Newark, NJ, United States.
- Bell, C.** Thomsen, M. Bhanji, J., Delgado, M., LoBue, V. (2023). *The Influence of Gun Violence Exposure on Threat Responses*. Poster presented at the biennial Princeton Summit on Affective Science, Princeton, NJ, United States.
- Anzures, G., Mildort, M., Soethe, E., & **Bell, C.** (2023). *Implicit Racial Bias and Visual Scanning of Own- and Other-race Faces in Children and Adults*. Poster presented at the biennial Society for the Study of Human Development, Philadelphia, PA, United States.
- Conley, M.I., Rapuano, K.M., Benson-Williams, C., Rosenberg, M.D., Watts, R., **Bell, C.**, Casey, BJ, & Baskin-Sommers, A. (2022). *Person-centered profiles of multicontextual perceived threat show distinct patterns of neural activation during an emotional working memory task*. Poster presented at the annual Association for Psychological Science Convention, Chicago, IL, United States.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- | | |
|-----------|--|
| 2024-2027 | NSF Graduate Research Fellowship (\$159,000)
National Science Foundation |
| 2024 | Harold Siegel Service Award (\$250)
Rutgers University—Newark |
| 2022-2027 | Presidential Fellowship (\$75,000)
Rutgers University—Newark |
| 2022-2024 | NIH Graduate Research Training Initiative for Student Enhancement (G-RISE) T32 Fellowship (\$112,000)
Rutgers University—Newark |
| 2018 | Outstanding Researcher Award (\$200)
University of Florida, Behavioral Medicine Lab |
| 2018 | Teaching and Leadership Award
University of Florida, Introduction to Health Disparities |
| 2018 | MCDA Inclusive Excellence in Diversity Student Organization Award
“Together UF”
University of Florida, Student Activities and Involvement |
| 2017 | Researcher of the Semester Award
University of Florida, Behavioral Medicine Lab |
| 2017 | Teaching and Leadership Award
University of Florida, Introduction to Health Disparities |
| 2016 | Inducted member of the Career Success Institute
University of Florida, Career Resource Center |

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2022-Present **Child Study Center**, Rutgers University—Newark
Primary Mentor: Dr. Vanessa LoBue

- Research focus: Multimethod research (e.g., ERP, eye-tracking) examining the implications of exposure to violence across development from infancy to young adulthood.
- 2022-Present **Delgado Lab**, Rutgers University—Newark
Second Mentor: Dr. Mauricio Delgado
Research focus: Neural (fMRI) mechanisms underlying exposure to violence.
- 2021-2022 **Fundamentals of the Adolescent Brain Lab**, Yale University
Mentor: Dr. BJ Casey
Research focus: The Adolescent Brain Cognitive Development (ABCD) Study. A ten-year longitudinal study of 12,000 adolescents across the nation examining the dynamic relationship between experience, and brain and behavior.
- 2018-2021 **Human Development Lab**, Florida Atlantic University
Mentor: Dr. Gizelle Anzures
Research focus: The role of experience in shaping developmental changes in visual perception and brain function of socially relevant stimuli using ERP.
- 2016-2018 **Behavioral Medicine Lab**, University of Florida
Mentor: Dr. Carolyn Tucker
Research focus: Interventions to reduce health disparities among low-income and minoritized populations in Jacksonville, FL.

TEACHING AND MENTORING EXPERIENCE

- 2025 REU Graduate Student Mentor, Rutgers University—Newark
Trained two undergraduate students participating in the Research Experience for Undergraduates program supported by the National Science Foundation, from Virginia Commonwealth University and Rider University. The students each assisted with different projects and presented posters on their summer findings.
- 2023-Present **Graduate Student Mentor**, Rutgers University—Newark
Trained 15 undergraduates on data analysis tasks, recruitment, Python coding, and in-person/online data collection. Under my supervision, 7 students completed and presented posters at various conference events.
- 2024 **SURI Graduate Student Mentor**, Rutgers University—Newark
Trained an undergraduate student participating in the Summer Undergraduate Research Institute, from the University of South Carolina Beaufort. The student presented a poster on their summer research activities.
- 2020 **First Year Connections Program Mentor**, Florida Atlantic University
Guided a first-year, first-generation undergraduate student on navigating the university, and future steps to succeed in academia.
- 2017-2018 **Teaching Assistant**, University of Florida
PCO 4911: Undergraduate Research in Psychology of Health Disparities
Led a weekly small class session with 5 undergraduate students.
- 2016 **Teaching Assistant**, University of Florida
PSY 2012: General Psychology
Assisted in preparing materials and grading for a class of 50 undergraduates.

SERVICE AND OUTREACH

2024-2026	Research Week Judge , Rutgers University—Newark Judged three student posters presented during Rutgers University's Annual Research Week. Provided scoring that was used to select poster awards.
2024	Application Reviewer , Application Statement Feedback Program Provided high-level feedback to six potential PhD applicants on their Statements of Purpose—the program focuses on underrepresented minorities in psychology.
2023-2025	Graduate Student Representative , Rutgers University—Newark Selected to be a co-student representative for the Psychology Department. Organized events, ran the department social media, managed 4 sub-committees, acted as a liaison between graduate students and the Department Chair and Graduate Advisor.
2023-2025	Colloquium Committee Leader , Rutgers University—Newark Organized the yearly colloquium speaker series (2023-2024; 2024-2025) in the Psychology Department in collaboration with three other students and a faculty advisor. Speaker series had 6 speakers from other universities.
2023-2024	Diversity Equity & Inclusion Committee Lead , Rutgers University—Newark Distributed the department annual climate survey, analyzed the responses and made recommendations to the department accordingly. Organized resources and events to ensure graduate student's success.
2023-2024	APA Campus Ambassador , American Psychological Association Spread awareness of the APA's student membership and benefits by providing a free year of membership for first time sign ups.
2017-2018	TogetherUF , University of Florida Initiated and produced a virtual assembly centered around race relations, religion, political views, and hate speech, which included dialogue from students and faculty regarding the campus climate, and resources. The assembly aired (over 800 UF viewers) the same time Richard Spencer (White Nationalist) gave a speech on campus.
2017-2018	Women's Student Association Co-President , University of Florida Addressed women's issues on campus, and augmented intersectionality among women by managing one of the largest student organizations on campus. Organized a campaign to secure funding for free menstrual products in campus facilities to aid low-income students, ran service drives for suicide prevention, sexual assault awareness, the PACE Center for Girls, a women's homeless shelter, and survivors of Hurricane Harvey in Texas.
2016-2017	Women's Student Association Conference Director , University of Florida Spread awareness of women's issues and strived to make a change within the university culture through conferences and various Women History Month programs and events.